

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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The song of songs, which is Solomon's.
(Song of Solomon 1:1)
This was Solomon's song
What is our song?



It is this opening statement of the book of Songs that inspired me a few days ago.

This is what stood out to me – THIS WAS SOLOMON'S SONG.

IT WAS HIS SONG BECAUSE HE WROTE IT AND SANG IT.

IT WAS HIS SONG OF LOVE.

Solomon's song was "the most excellent of them all." AMP

His song was "more wonderful than any other." NLT

*It was the most **Excellent Love Song.**" NET*

HIS SONG WAS ALSO A SONG:

- Of pure delight,
- Of immense satisfaction,
- Of joy and happiness,
- Of devotion and commitment,
- Of a wonderful passionate feeling of beauty and enjoyment,
- Of love for his bride.

I then asked myself – **'WHAT ABOUT MY SONG?'**

What is **my** song like?

What kind of song do I consistently sing?

What are its lyrics – and the message of **my song**?

Does **my song** express the same passion and enjoyment of love as **Solomon's song**?

Does **my song** reveal the love and passionate delight that I have for my lover – the one who loves me, **Jesus Christ**?

Does **my song** unveil that I am a **fervent** and **devoted lover** of my Shepherd King - Jesus?

Is the language I use to speak of my lover (Jesus) filled with love and deep emotional feeling?

Is my song overflowing with a longing affection and thirst for the closeness of a love relationship with my Lord?

Is my song filled with a memorable melody of genuine EMOTION that lingers in the hearer's ear?

Is there a sweetness about my song that expresses a deep and lasting affection for my shepherd king – Jesus

MY SONG CAN BE YOUR SONG ALSO.

WHAT IS YOUR SONG?

Example.

EZEKIEL'S SONG. (the prophet) Ezekiel 33:31-32

Who sang love songs – but it did not produce lovers

Ezekiel 33:31-32

31 My people come to you, as they usually do, and sit before you to listen to your words, but they do not put them into practice. With their mouths they express devotion, but their hearts are greedy for unjust gain. 32 Indeed, to them you are nothing more than one who sings love songs with a beautiful voice and plays an instrument well, for they hear your words but do not put them into practice. NIV

ISRAEL acknowledged that Ezekiel the prophet skillfully played a guitar and **sang love songs – songs of God's amazing love –** but the people never intended to become **LOVERS** of God and his ways.

Sadly, they only saw him as **A GOOD ENTERTAINER.**

Ezekiel 33:32 "You are **very entertaining to them, like someone who sings love songs** with a beautiful voice or plays fine music on an instrument...." NLT

This then raises an interesting question.

As believers, we also are singers of love songs – hymns/psalms, etc. **and it should have strengthened and intensified our love for Christ?**

IT SHOULD HAVE MADE US PASSIONATE LOVERS.

LOVERS OF JESUS.

True lovers are those **who keep his commandments – they are obedient.**

John 14:21 Whoever has my commands and obeys them, he is the one who loves me...." NIV

John 14:24 He who does not love me will not obey my teaching...." NIV

Obedience of our lives to Christ is what affirms us as true lovers.

Have we become lovers of God in the truest sense of the word?

THE DANGER facing us all

That even though we sincerely and earnestly sing **love songs - songs of God's love**, but we fail to become passionate **LOVERS** – then in a sense we are just **entertaining**.

And I'm sure none of us want to be like that.

TOTAL SURRENDER OF OUR LIVES TO CHRIST IS WHAT AFFIRMS OUR BEING LOVERS.

MY SONG – OUR SONG

IN OUR EVANGELISM DO WE SPEAK OF HIM IN LOVING TERMS (expressions of our being in love) TO THOSE WHO HAVE NEVER KNOWN HIS SAVING GRACE?

DO WE SING? - CAN WE SING?

There are some people who seldom sing.

And for others it has been a long time since they spontaneously burst into song.

Then there are those who find it difficult to sing because of past tragedy in their lives that has inhibited/prevented them to sing.

GOD PUT A SONG IN OUR HEARTS AT SALVATION.

God Put in our mouth a song so we can sing the songs of love and praise to him.

THE SONG OF SALVATION

Is something so wonderful and precious that we ought to be singing about it with affection and love for ALL of our lives.

Psalms 40:2-3

2 He lifted me out of the slimy pit, out of the mud and mire; he set my feet on a rock and gave me a firm place to stand. 3 He put a new song in my mouth, a hymn of praise to our God. Many will see and fear and put their trust in the Lord. NIV

MAKING MUSIC in our hearts

We are to produce lyrics that we can sing.

Ephesians 5:18-20 - be filled with the Spirit:

19 speaking to one another in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, singing and making music to the Lord in your heart,

20 giving thanks always for everything to God the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, Holman

Colossians 3:16 Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom and as you sing psalms, hymns and spiritual songs with gratitude in your hearts to God. NIV

THE SONG OF SALVATION –

SO DON'T LOSE THE MUSIC IN YOUR LIFE.

DON'T STOP SINGING THE SONGS OF SALVATION.

They will refresh and keep our spirit sweet and filled with spiritual melody.

Amen – Ps Barry